The mock API server is included with this book. It uses LiveView to provide a real-time interface to view the SMS messages that have passed through it. And it uses a GenServer to hold the SMS state. This makes it a great resource to look at after you've completed the project.

To start, we'll generate our application skeleton.

Create an Empty Phoenix App

Phoenix is the primary web development framework in the Elixir ecosystem. It's a bit like Ruby on Rails, although future chapters will talk about how different they are. We aren't going to dig into Phoenix beyond this short introduction yet, but we are going to use its generator to make our initial project directory.

Phoenix's generator provides us with a web server, a database client, and more. Everything is correctly set up from the beginning so it works right out of the box. This gives us the fastest path to using Ecto.

The installation instructions[2] on Phoenix's documentation give us everything we need to get started. Follow along with these directions to get started. Make sure that you have at least Elixir 1.14 and Erlang/OTP 25 installed. (This book uses more recent versions that you can find in Install Elixir on Your Computer, on page 10.)

```
$ mix local.hex
Are you sure you want to... [Yn] Y

$ mix archive.install hex phx_new
Are you sure you want to... [Yn] Y

# It's very important to use the name "phone_app"
$ mix phx.new phone_app
Fetch and install dependencies? [Yn] Y

$ cd phone_app

$ mix ecto.create
The database for PhoneApp.Repo has been created

$ mix test
.....
Finished in 0.2 seconds (0.1s async, 0.1s sync)
5 tests, 0 failures
```

If everything is green with your tests, then you're good to go with the rest of this chapter. If you run into issues, then make sure that you have Postgres installed and that you have the latest versions of Elixir and Erlang.

2. https://hexdocs.pm/phoenix/installation.html